



LANDZILLE

E-MAGAZINE ISSUE NO. 14 | 01.05.2026

ISSUE DETAILS: MAY, 2026

YOUR TRUSTED GUIDE TO SMART LAND INVESTMENTS.



I AM LAND
OPEN GROUND

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1. FROM THE CEO'S DESK: THE GROUND SHIFTS IN APRIL

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My mother used to say "Akin, the best time to plant was yesterday. The second best time is right now."

She was not talking about real estate but about life.

About the particular regret that comes from knowing the moment was there; ripe, open, yours and watching yourself hesitate anyway.

I think about her words every May.

Because something happens this month that I cannot explain with data alone. People wake up, not from sleep but from waiting. From the comfortable numbness of **not yet** and **maybe later** and **let me see how the market moves first**.

May has a way of making all of that feel suddenly, urgently foolish.

The days are longer, the deals are real and somewhere out there, a piece of ground is sitting open not forever, just for now with your name quietly attached to it. This issue will not tell you to rush. But it will ask you one honest question:

What are you still waiting for?

Welcome to Open Ground.

With warmth,

Akingbade Akinfenwa

Founder & CEO, Landzille



2. THE BUYING FEVER



There is a particular kind of restlessness that arrives every May.

You feel it in the open house foot traffic, in the bidding conversations that suddenly have more participants than anyone expected and in the way people who swore they were going to wait for rates to drop, for prices to soften, for the *right time* suddenly stop waiting. Call it the buying fever. It comes around every spring like clockwork, and 2026 is no different.

But here is what the fever actually tells us: What the spring surge reveals, every single year, is a fundamental truth about human beings and land: **people do not buy when conditions are perfect. They buy when they can no longer stand not owning.** The urgency is not economic rather it is emotional and biological. There is something in the longer days, the warmer earth, the visible horizon that makes people look around and ask ***why am I renting someone else's future?***

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Nowhere is this more visible right now than in North Texas. ***Dallas-Fort Worth has ranked as the number one real estate market to watch for the second consecutive year, according to PwC and the Urban Land Institute's annual Emerging Trends report topping both the commercial and homebuilding prospects lists.*** The DFW Metroplex now carries a population of over 7.6 million residents, continuing to be one of the fastest-growing metropolitan areas in the entire nation.

But the more interesting story isn't happening in the gleaming corridors of downtown Dallas. It's happening further out, in the quieter counties and on the open ground. ***Researchers at the University of Texas at Arlington have identified what they're calling the "Westoplex" a next major growth frontier emerging across Fort Worth and surrounding western counties, as the eastern side of the Metroplex,*** particularly Dallas, Collin, and Denton counties, becomes constrained by limited land and rising development costs. The pressure is moving outward, and it is moving fast. This is where Gainesville, Leonard, and Roxton enter the conversation. In February 2026, a ***prominent DFW real estate agent purchased more than 800 acres north of Gainesville for a major mixed-use development plan*** that included up to one thousand family homes and two to three thousand apartment units, sitting directly off Interstate 35. This is a conviction play on the future of North Texas growth corridors.

Gainesville, Leonard, Roxton: these are not afterthoughts on the map. They are the map's next chapter. As metro land becomes scarcer and pricier, the counties that sit within reach of the DFW orbit become the natural pressure valve. Smaller towns and suburbs around Texas's major metros are now experiencing the most significant growth, as families and companies choose these areas for their affordability, strong schools, and small-town character. **Fannin County; home to Leonard and Roxton** sits in that precise sweet spot: close enough to the Metroplex to benefit from its economic gravity, far enough to still offer land at prices that make real wealth-building possible. That window is not permanent.

This fever, when you think about it, isn't irrational. It is information and your instincts telling you something your spreadsheet hasn't fully calculated yet. The spring surge is not hysteria. It is humanity collectively recognising that open ground does not stay open and that the people who act while the fever is high are rarely the ones who regret it.

3. THE DEED BEFORE THE DREAM



Most people have the sequence wrong, they spend months sometimes years dreaming about what land ownership could look like: the possibilities, legacy and long-term return. They build a vision so detailed and so beautiful that it starts to feel like progress but it isn't.

Because while they are dreaming, someone else is signing. This is the quiet tragedy playing out across the American real estate market right now, and nowhere more visibly than in the spring season. May arrives, listings surge, energy spikes and a certain kind of person gets inspired and they start imagining, planning, and also tell themselves they are almost ready. Almost is the most expensive word in real estate.

NAR Chief Economist Lawrence Yun is forecasting a 14% nationwide increase in home sales for 2026, following two years of suppressed activity building up like water behind a dam. That demand does not release gradually. It moves fast, it moves in clusters, and it moves first toward the people who are already positioned. The ones already positioned did not wait until they felt ready. They understood something essential: **ownership is not the reward for a perfect plan. It is the beginning of one.**

The deed comes first. The dream gets built on top of it. This distinction sounds simple. It is not, it requires a particular kind of discipline, the ability to act on conviction before comfort catches up, to put your name on something before the story of that something is fully written. Of the 9 million people added to the U.S. population in the past five years, nearly 25% relocated to Texas and that population doesn't stop moving once it hits the major metros. It keeps pressing outward, into the corridors, the county seats, the quieter towns that sit within reach of everything but still feel like somewhere.

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North Texas is full of those places right now. Bonham. Honey Grove. Wolfe City. Towns where the infrastructure is arriving, the water projects are completing, the master plans are being drawn and where land can still be acquired before the market finishes its sentence.

There is a particular kind of person who researches everything and owns nothing, they know the cap rates, read the forecasts, understand the thesis completely and they are waiting, always waiting, for one more piece of confirmation before they move. What they don't account for is this: Texas rural land prices are expected to hold near recent levels or trend slightly upward through 2026, with sales activity picking up as interest rates ease.

The window that feels open today quietly narrows. Not dramatically or with an announcement, it just gets a little more expensive, a little more competitive, and a little harder to enter each season you sit out. The dream, held long enough without action, becomes a regret. The deed, signed with imperfect information and honest conviction, becomes a foundation.

That is the only sequence that has ever worked on land. Own first, optimize later.

The market rewards the decisive, not the inspired.



4. PRICED IN

Numbers don't lie, they do whisper and if you have spent any time around real estate markets really spent time, not just reading headlines you learn that the most important information is rarely the loudest. It sits just underneath the surface figure and the gap between what sold and what didn't, is like the relationship between a rising price and a falling transaction count and in the quiet tension of a market that looks stable on paper but is coiling underneath.

The US median home price hit \$436,412 in March 2026, up 1.1% year over year, even as existing home sales fell 3.6%. Most people read that and see a slowing market, what it actually describes is a market where prices are rising despite fewer transactions which means the constraint is not desired, it is supply. NAR estimates that an additional 300,000 to 500,000 homes/lands would be needed just to bring inventory back to normal conditions. That is not a small gap, that is a structural deficit that has been building for years and it does not fix itself quickly, quietly, or cheaply. Meanwhile, home sales are expected to reach 4.25 million in 2026, a 5% increase from 2025, as easing mortgage rates draw more buyers back into the market. More buyers, same constrained supply. The math on that is not complicated, it is the national average that tells you very little about where the opportunity actually lives.

Year-over-year sales rose in the South and West in 2026 while declining in the Northeast and Midwest. That divergence is not new but it is deepening and the population is moving south, the capital is following. And in North Texas specifically, the land sitting in the path of that movement in the counties, the corridors, the quieter towns within reach of DFW has not yet fully absorbed what is coming. That is what "priced in" means when it works in your favour. Not that everyone already knows. But that you already know and you moved while the market was still catching up.

The numbers are talking. The only question is who is listening.



5. THE LAST OPEN LOT



There is a specific kind of regret that lives in real estate.

It is not the regret of a bad investment because bad investments sting and then fade. This regret is quieter, more stubborn, it is the regret of the right piece of land, at the right time, at the right price and the decision to wait. To think about it a little longer and to come back next week only to discover that it is gone. If you have felt that, you already understand what this chapter is about. If you haven't, read carefully because the market right now is engineered to produce exactly that feeling, and the data behind it is not subtle.



A landmark analysis of land listings released by Realtor.com this April, the first of its kind found that US land inventory has contracted 23.6% since early 2019 and has yet to recover, while the median price per acre has surged 76.6% over the same period in Q1 2026.

What makes this finding different from a typical market report is the permanence embedded in it. **Senior Realtor.com economist Joel Berner put it plainly: "When a builder develops a parcel, that land never returns to the market." It is consumed, converted, gone** and unlike the broader housing market where inventory has clawed back roughly 20% year over year, vacant land inventory has made virtually no progress toward pre-pandemic levels. The supply side of this market is not recovering. It is restructuring permanently around a smaller pool of available land at higher prices and the buyers who understood that earliest are already sitting on the right side of that shift.

In Texas, the numbers carry their own particular texture. **Texas has already lost nearly 3.7 million acres of working lands since 1997**, much of it converted to development and infrastructure near the state's largest metro areas. That loss does not reverse. The land nearest to DFW in Cooke, Fannin, and Hunt Counties is being absorbed into the metropolitan orbit one parcel at a time, and the parcels that remain outside that orbit today are precisely the ones that command tomorrow's premium.

Here is what nobody tells you about the last open lot. It does not announce itself as the last one. It arrives looking like any other opportunity; available, reasonably priced, a little imperfect around the edges and the temptation is always the same: to weigh it against some imagined future option that will be cleaner, cheaper, better timed. That future option rarely arrives, what arrives instead is the news that someone else signed, that the price moved and that the corridor you were watching quietly filled in while you were deciding.

In North Texas, in the counties and corridors where I AM LAND operates, where the lakes are filling and the master plans are being drawn and the infrastructure is arriving; the last open lot is not a dramatic moment, it is a quiet one. A parcel that was listed, then wasn't, a price that made sense, then didn't and a window that felt permanent, until the morning it closed. The investors who win in this market are not the ones who moved fast, they are the ones who moved *before fast was necessary*, who understood that open ground, by its very nature, is temporary and that the cost of waiting is not just financial.

It is the weight of knowing the lot was there.

And you almost bought it.

6. LANDZILLE RECOMMENDS: BOOK & EVENTS

BOOK OF THE MONTH

The Impact of Airport on Economic Development by Akingbade Akinfenwa



This book gives a refined exploration of the impact of infrastructures like Airport development and growth fundamentals shaping investment appeal. Download it free at [RESOURCES](#)

UPCOMING & RECENT EVENT:

CHAPTER ROXTON IS LIVE!:

Still Interested in Roxton? Act Now! Last month we announced it and now, the lots are almost gone. Just two 13–15 acre parcels remain! The buyers who moved early already have their acre. Reach out to Landzille today. Don't let someone else take your plot! [Roxton, Texas: The next chapter in smart land investment is live!](#)

BEHIND THE BUILD: REFINING THE FUTURE WITH GEOTELA

The journey from concept to creation continues with an interesting twist. Behind the scenes at GEOTELA, deep brainstorming, mind-stretching conversations, and idea-birthing sessions are refining an exceptional vision. The foundation is set, the direction is clear, and every screen, integration, and feature is being built with purpose. We're closer than ever!

COMMUNITY EVENT RECAP

Last month, Landzille was on the ground in Dallas, Tx at the **ConnectPro World Networking Event** alongside the country's top successful DFW professionals, Recruiters and business owners. A room where mindset shifts from survival to wealth, strategy and opportunities. Landzille was represented.





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